Frida Kahlo

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

INSTRUCTIONS

Read about the artist. Answer the questions in full sentences. Then complete the drawing task at the bottom.

MEET THE ARTIST

Frida Kahlo was born in 1907 in Coyoacán, near Mexico City, in a house painted bright blue. When she was eighteen she was badly hurt in a bus accident and had to spend months in bed. Her parents fixed a mirror above her bed and gave her paints, and she began to paint herself. Of her 143 paintings, 55 are self-portraits. Frida painted what she felt as well as what she saw: her pictures are full of bright colours, flowers in her hair, monkeys, parrots and symbols from Mexican history and culture. She wore traditional Mexican dresses and was proud of her country. Today her Blue House is a museum where visitors can see her paints, her clothes and her garden.

QUESTIONS

1. What happened to Frida when she was eighteen?

_____

2. How did her parents help her start painting?

_____

3. What is a self-portrait? How many did Frida paint?

_____

4. List three things that often appear in her paintings.

_____

5. What can visitors see at the Blue House today?

_____

YOUR TURN

Draw a self-portrait like Frida: look straight at the viewer and surround yourself with three things that show who you are (a pet, a plant, a symbol of your family or country).

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Frida Kahlo - Answer key

1. She was badly hurt in a bus accident and spent months in bed.

2. They fixed a mirror above her bed and gave her paints.

3. A picture an artist makes of themselves; 55.

4. Any three of: bright colours, flowers in her hair, monkeys, parrots, symbols from Mexican history and culture.

5. Her paints, her clothes and her garden (it is a museum).

YOUR TURN: Drawing task; no single answer.

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